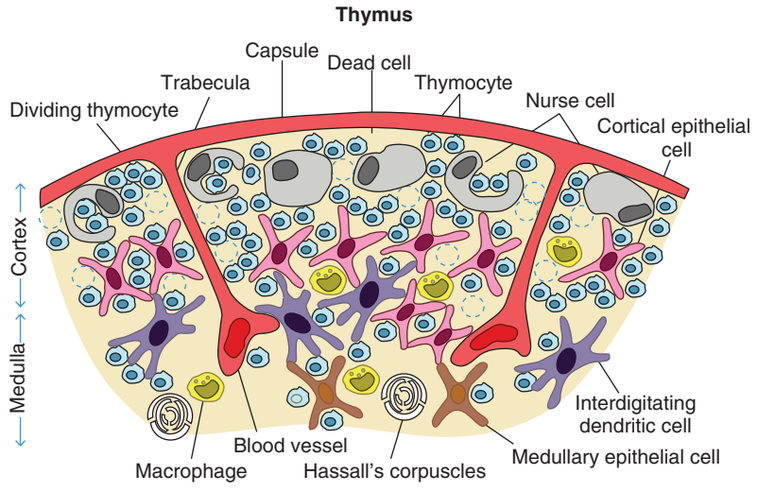


Figure 13.3: Diagrammatic Cross-section of a portion of the thymus

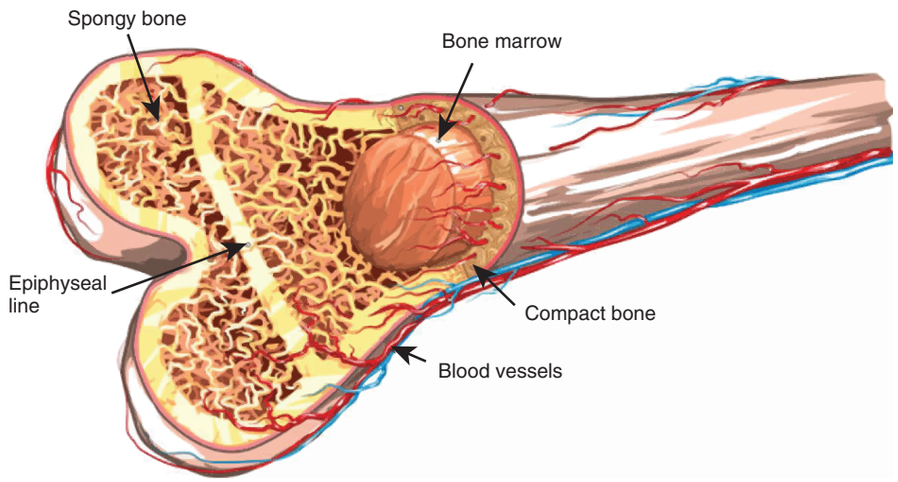


Figure 13.4: Structure of Bone marrow

thymic selection during T cell maturation, a selection process within the bone marrow eliminates non functioning B cells and those bearing self reactive antigen receptors. In birds, undifferentiated lymphocytes move from the bone marrow to the Bursa of Fabricius, where B cell mature; this is where B cells were first identified and how they came to be known as " B" (for bursa) cells.

13.2.2 Secondary Lymphoid Organs

a. Spleen

The spleen is the most highly organized secondary lymphoid organ. The spleen is a fist sized organ just behind the stomach. It collects and disposes of aged red blood cells. Its organization is shown schematically in Figure 13.5. The bulk of the spleen is composed of red pulp which is the site of red blood cell disposal. The spleen is not supplied by lymphatic vessels. The lymphocytes surround the arterioles entering the spleen, forming areas of white pulp. The inner region of white pulp is

TN_GOVT_XI_Micro_Biology_CH13.indd 219 16-02-2019 10.36.02 AM